# MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD & Platform Infrastructure

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including recent work on CI/CD pipelines, test infrastructure and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and Helm-based ephemeral test environments for three product teams, documents the CI system for onboarding, and mentors junior QA engineers. Personal infrastructure projects include a k3s cluster with GitOps and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure. Currently preparing for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam; not yet certified.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Infrastructure & CI/CD:** GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal project), Ansible (basic)

**Containers & GitOps:** Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s, Argo CD

**Monitoring & observability:** Prometheus, Grafana, Loki

**Programming & scripting:** Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL

**Testing:** pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

**Systems & data:** Linux, Git, PostgreSQL

**Cloud learning:** AWS EC2 and S3 basics (free-tier learning); Hetzner VPS

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present**

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering builds, unit/integration/e2e tests and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating e2e testing into its own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived, merge-request test environments for applications, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed through GitLab CI using Docker Compose and later Helm to namespace-level environments on the shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright e2e suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Developed Bash and Python tools for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote an internal guide to the CI system used in onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

**QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021**

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications across client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

**Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019**

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

## SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT

**Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal project | 2024–2025**

- Set up a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Configured Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform in a personal project.

## EDUCATION

**BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018**

## CERTIFICATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam preparation; exam booked for January 2027 (not yet certified)

## LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)